Coding the Digital Edition Report

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MA Digital Humanities

1. Introduction

The Coding the Digital Edition course provided a lot of important knowledge for producing a Digital Scholarly Edition. Some of them are: how to think about the technological structure to make a Digital Edition, the basic necessary tools and the programming logic behind them, and the materials available to make a Digital Edition, in our case, the magazine. My expectations regarding the course were met because what I expected was to understand the concept of producing a Digital Edition and its technological implications. Despite having previous knowledge of the languages learned in the course, I was also expecting to learn more about how to interact with them through an API, which was met in the interaction with the images and texts provided.

Some of the materials we used, in addition to the HTML, CSS and JS programming languages, were copies of the women's magazine “Mode und Heim”, made available by the Digital Library Mecklenburg-Vorpommern. The available material is from 1895 to 1909, and my issue of copy was number 25 from the year 1904. In addition, we also used some external tutorials as material, such as the w3 tutorial for CSS[1], the website Fontsquirrel[2], and the softwares Visual Studio Code, GIMP and Inkscape.

2. Reflection on HTML, CSS and JS

The choice of using HTML, CSS and JS to create a Digital Edition brings independence in terms of being able to create various digital tools according to what we want. While HTML, according to the w3 wiki, is “HTML stands for HyperText Markup Language. It is used to create Web pages. That is, Web pages all over the world consist of HTML” therefore, it means that everything described on the web page is marked by tags. It is as if it were the skeleton of a material, where it contains only text with its respective markings and definitions. For example, all headings are marked with the

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[1] https://www.w3schools.com/css/css_grid.asp

[2] https://www.fontsquirrel.com/matcherator

letter <h>, to identify their role in the document. It is also necessary to establish semantic and hierarchical relationships, for example when there is a “child” tag. HTML represents the “raw” content that the browser will interpret.

CSS participates in this structure by providing aesthetic changes on top of HTML. CSS also reinforces hierarchical and semantic relationships from the moment it gives more or less emphasis to some information. It is possible to increase the font size, center it, hide it, or simply make it more visually pleasing and more accessible. It is important to understand that aesthetics are also important in the information that will be conveyed, not only in terms of intentions, but, for example, the use of typography according to the original material - or whatever comes closest to it - also concerns maintaining the originality of the document and the interpretations that can be made of it. The idea behind CSS is to give a visual layer to raw text created from HTML.

Javascript is a programming language that deals with the functioning of the page in its actions and interactions. It is through Javascript that it is possible to interact with an API, create functionalities and make the page more dynamic. An example of this functioning is page switching. If, for example, a material with HTML and CSS were made available on a single page, reading it would not “simulate” the page switching simulated in the action of reading a magazine, and it would also make the document more tiring to read. Therefore, one of Javascript’s tasks is to take the HTML text, along with the CSS modifications, and turn it into something that interacts, either with other pages or with the user. In addition, Javascript also makes modifications to the HTML and CSS themselves, according to the intention.

Javascript, together with HTML and CSS, allows the Digital Edition to be not only a digital visualization, but also a research tool, allowing, for example, the download of the original image according to the modifications made by the user.

3. **Describing an example**

The page chosen to serve as an example is the first page of my issue, which is attached as Figure 1. To begin with, there is an illustration of the magazine's header, which begins as a challenge between image and text. The illustration is very ornate and takes up at least a quarter of the magazine's page, making its presence in the Digital Edition as an image very important. After this, there is a line of text divided into 3

columns, with information about the issue number, a sentence and the year of publication. Below this is a small box with an ornate outline, also divided into 3 columns, containing a small ornament, some text and again a small ornament. The text is divided, one part inside the box, and the other attached below.

After this, what can be considered the “content” of the issue are three columns that are outlined by an ornament that goes all the way to the end of the page. The first column has a blank space, the section title, and indented text that goes all the way to the end of the page and, at its end, deviates slightly from the outline ornament. The image is in the center of the page, with its caption at the bottom in a smaller size. Part of the model's arm in the figure is extending beyond the image's limits, but there is still space between it and the text. The third column of text, again, is a block that goes all the way to the end of the page, has indentation only at the beginning of the other paragraph, and deviates from the ornament in the corner of the page.

Regarding the header illustration, it is possible to add it as an image from a scan of the issue, cropped in GIMP and inserted into the page along with the SVG node, which is what we did. One of the limitations is the demarcation of the text written in the header. The lines of text with information about the Issue and Year can be represented with different or a table. The ornamented box with the text can be represented in a division of three columns structured with flexbox or grid, and the image of the ornament that surrounds it must have a transparent background, and the text will be placed “inside” the image. One of the limitations is the adjustment of the page according to the screen size and the outline.

The text divided into three columns and surrounded by ornaments can be recreated on a website using CSS grid or columns. The ornament that surrounds the text can be created with background images, but with the same challenge as the previous ornament of maintaining the responsiveness of the page.

Just like the header, the image can be incorporated into the page by extracting it from GIMP and adding it as an SVG node. The main limitation is adapting the printed layout to mobile devices. A magazine layout with columns and ornaments was designed for a fixed page, while a website needs to be responsive to work on screens of different

sizes. This may require compromises in the original aesthetic to ensure readability on cell phones and tablets, and the font may not be the original, but just a similar one.

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that surrounds the text can be created with background images, but with the same challenge as the previous ornament of maintaining the responsiveness of the page.

4. **Final reflection**

What I learned in this course was how to represent digital editions from web pages using the tools studied in the form of Code-Along-Exercise, HTML, CSS and JS and even the logic of the API. I learned how these tools interact with each other, and how it is possible to develop an object of study through this. Transforming the digitized issues into digital editions gives the possibility of acquiring new knowledge from them.

The study of digital editions will be very important for my own research, as I intend to continue studying both digital editions and women's magazines. From the Digital Edition it is possible to interpret, display and share a lot of information and study contained in the original document. My next steps would be to make the page more responsive and more similar to the original, the texts according to their respective columns, and develop some method that will help me analyze the images from the digital edition. The arrangement of images is very important in the page layout, and inserting the images along with the ornament would be my next step.

One of the great difficulties of digital editions is representing the materiality and the image study, and giving due importance to all other information that is not text. To this end, one of the challenges is already being solved by leaving the images in their places according to the page layout. Another way to make this visible is to add digital tools to better visualize the page, such as the magnifying glass that I used, or some tool that searches for similar images in large issues with several images, adding, for example, its embeddings made by some algorithm.

To conclude by answering whether what we did is a critical digital edition, according to the footnote in Patrick Sahle's text, in Peter Robinson's article "What is a Critical Digital Edition?" (Variants: The Journal of the European Society for Textual Scholarship, 1, 2002, 43-62), six essential aspects of a critical digital edition are identified: (1) a critical digital edition is anchored in a historical analysis of the materials; (2) a critical digital edition presents hypotheses about creation and change; (3) a critical digital edition supplies a record and classification over time, in many dimensions and in appropriate detail; (4) a critical digital edition may present an edited text, among all the

texts it offers; (5) a critical digital edition allows space and tools for readers to develop their own hypotheses and ways of reading; (6) a critical digital edition must offer all this in a manner that enriches reading.

Our result approximates aspects 5 by adding some tools to analyze the image, but it lacks a critical edition of the text and its historical analysis.

5. Bibliographical reference

Sahle, P. (2016). 2. What is a Scholarly Digital Edition? In Digital Scholarly Editing: Theories and Practices (pp. 19-39). Open Book Publishers. From https://books.openedition.org/obp/3397

W3C. (2013). HTML/Training/What_is_HTML/edit. From https://www.w3.org/wiki/HTML/Training/What_is_HTML/edit

6. Attachment

Mode und Heim

Nr. 25. Beilage zur Stralsundischen Zeitung. 1904

Schnitt-Muster zu Toiletten-, Konfektions- und Wäschegegenständen (auch nach Mass) aus festem Seidenpapier sind gegen Franko-Einsendung von 80 Pfg. (1 Frc.) per Muster von dem Verlage dieser Zeitschrift zu beziehen.

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Mode und Handarbeiten

Fig. 1 u. 2. Theaterkleider aus Musselinchiffon. Das Kleid zeigt einen gereihten Rock mit einer Grundform aus Taffet, die zugleich mit dem Rande des Oberrockes in die Besatzbinde genommen wird. Das Einreihen erfolgt über ganz dünne Passepoilschnürchen, die man gleich in entsprechender Weite nehmen kann. Der untere Rand des Grundrockes wird mit zwei Reihen Plisseevolants besetzt. Die Blusentaille schließt rückwärts mit Druckknöpfen. Sie wird auf einer anpassenden Futtergrundform hergestellt und mit einem Schnebbengürtel abgeschlossen, der in angegebener Art tief unterhalb des Taillenschlusses reicht und auf einer dünnen, mit Fischbeinstäbchen gestützten Futtergrundform hergestellt ist. Man verwendet zu diesem Gürtel entweder ein sehr breites Satin Liberty-Band oder schrägfadig geschnittenen Seidenstoff oder auch Samt und schließt den Gürtel rückwärts in der Mitte unter einem schmalen Köpfchen mit Haken. Der Oberstoff der Blusentaille wird am Halsrand dreimal eingezogen. Dieses Einreihen erfolgt mit Säumchenzügen, das heißt, man faßt den Stoff wie zu einem Säumchen auf die Nadel. Die Entfernung der einzelnen Zugreihen voneinander beträgt etwa 1½ Ctm., die Entfernung der einzelnen Gruppen richtet sich nach der Länge des Oberstoffes. Dieser hängt ringsum über und wird in der an der Abbildung ersichtlichen Weise von einem in Boleroform eingesetzten Einsatz aus Irishguipurespitze unterbrochen. Man heftet diesen auf, näht seine Kanten fest und entfernt dann erst den Oberstoff unter der Spitze. Die Aermel stehen breit ab, sind sehr faltig und werden, wie angegeben, mit Spitzeneinsätzen abgeschlossen, die in schräger Form anzubringen sind. Das Kleid hat keinen Stehkragen. Material: 10 bis 12 Mtr. Musselinchiffon, etwa 2½ Mtr. Guipurespitzen. — Fig. 2 zeigt ein schwarzes Musselinchiffonkleid mit spangenartig angebrachten Einsätzen aus Chantillyspitzen, die die Grundform aus Taffet durchschimmern lassen und mit à jour-Stichen zu befestigen sind. Der Oberstoff der Blusentaille, die ringsum ein wenig überhängt, wird in angegebener Art der Länge nach in der Mitte in Form dreier Säumchenzüge eingezogen, und seine Falten sind, wie angegeben, in schräger Richtung auszuspannen. Ebenso werden die Vorderteile mit Spangen verziert und faltig ausgespannt. Der Gürtel aus Satin Liberty-Band wird auf einer Grundform, die mit Fischbeinstäben gestützt ist, hergestellt. Die Aermel sind sowohl bei der äußeren als bei der inneren Kante der Länge nach einzureihen, wodurch sich der Oberstoff in Querfalten drapiert. Der am oberen Rande reichgereihte Rock wird aus runden Bahnen zusammengestellt liegt über einer mit plissierten Ansatzvolants versehenen Grundform aus Taffet, die ungefähr dreieinhalb bis vier Meter weit ist. Material: 12 Meter Musselinchiffon.

Figur 3. Ballkleid aus Musselinchiffon. Der ringsum reich eingereihte Rock fällt über eine Grundform aus gleichfarbigem Taffet, die mit einem rundgeschnittenen,

Fig. 8. Hauskleid mit Tuchrock und Samtbluse für junge Damen.

Figure 1. Issue number 25. 1904, page 1.